Background

- In clinical trials, we often want to see how the treatment is affecting some parameter of a subject
- To see the effect, we should have a reference value for each subject which can be used to compare the treatment effect with
- So, we measure the parameter one or more times before the start of the study treatment and use one of them as 'reference'.
- This reference is often called as the baseline value.
- Baseline flag is used to identify the record with reference value for each parameter of a subject
- It is often used for lab, vital signs, ECG, and similar findings domains where multiple records per subject may exist
- Baseline is typically defined as the last non-missing value on or prior to treatment start date
- In SDTM, the flag is stored in variables like `--BLFL` (e.g., `LBBLFL`, `VSBLFL`, etc.)
- The derivation depends on subject's treatment start date, which comes from the DM domain - RFSTDTC
- The records are filtered to those prior to or on treatment start, and the one with the latest date/time is flagged as baseline